Federal Reserve Bank *of* Atlanta

Labor Report First Look

The Labor Report First Look offers a snapshot of current and historical employment data. We will update the First Look's data with each release of the Employment Situation Summary from the US Bureau of Labor Statistics, which typically occurs on the first Friday of each month.

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29,000

Monthly change in total nonfarm payroll employment

4.2%

Unemployment rate

October 2026

Both nonfarm payroll employment (+29,000) and the unemployment rate (4.2 percent) changed little in September, the US Bureau of Labor Statistics reported today.

Updated: October 02, 2026

Next update: November 06, 2026

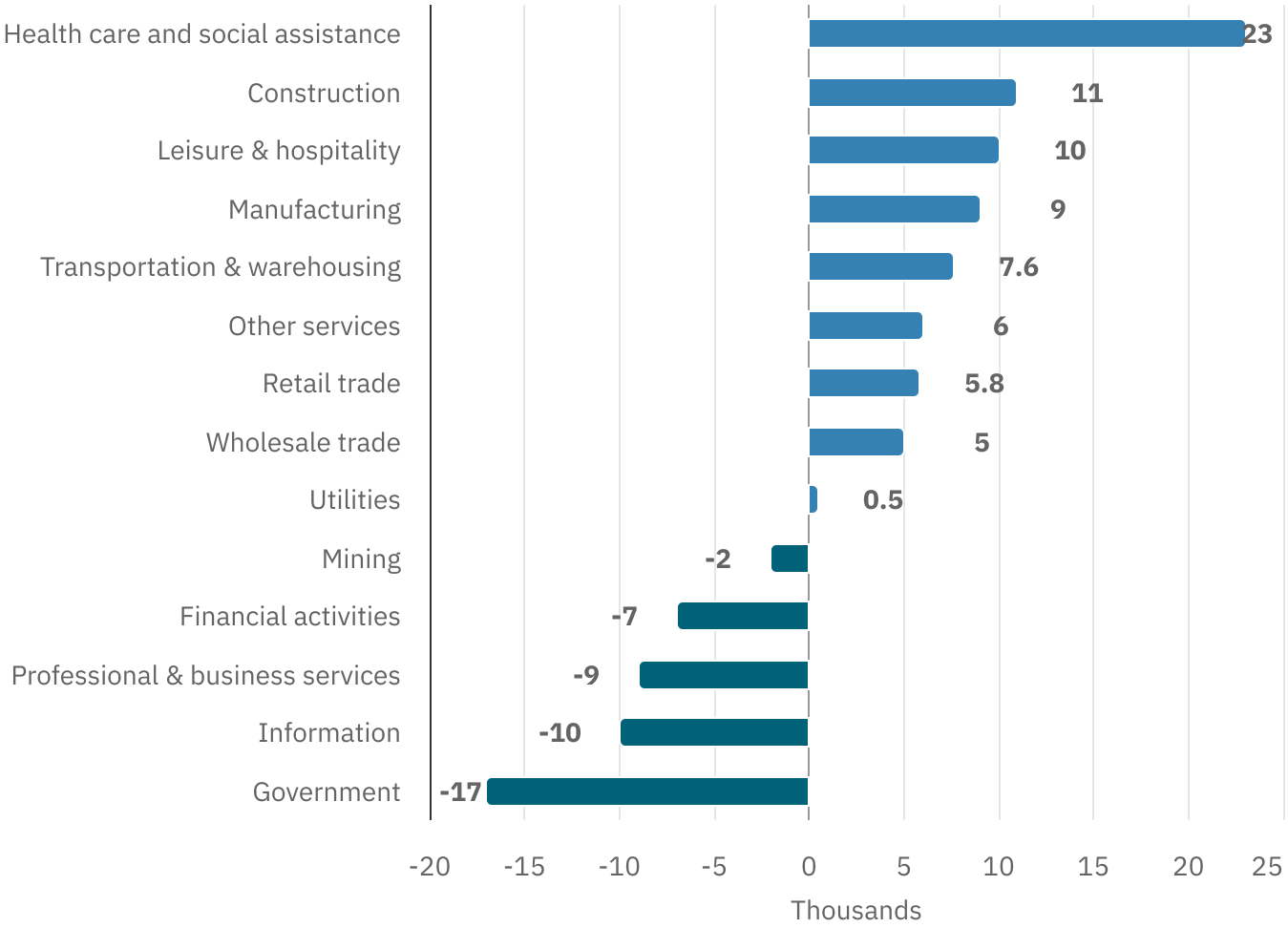
EMPLOYMENT	1-MONTH CHANGE (PRIOR ESTIMATE)[1]	12-MONTH AVERAGE CHANGE
September 2026	29K	41.33K

EMPLOYMENT	1-MONTH CHANGE (PRIOR ESTIMATE)[1]	12-MONTH AVERAGE CHANGE
August 2026	133K (162K)	45.25K
July 2026	-10K (21K)	28.33K
	12-MONTH CHANGE	
Average hourly earnings[2]		
September 2026	0.1%	3.0%

Note: Employment data are nonfarm, seasonally adjusted. Employment change is in thousands (denoted by K). Earnings and hours data are nonfarm private (excluding government), seasonally adjusted.
[1] The prior month's Employment Situation Report's estimate is in parentheses.
[2] Nominal earnings
Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics Summary Table B, Establishment data; Haver Analytics; Atlanta Fed calculations);

One-Month Employment Change Ranked by Industry
September 2026

Export

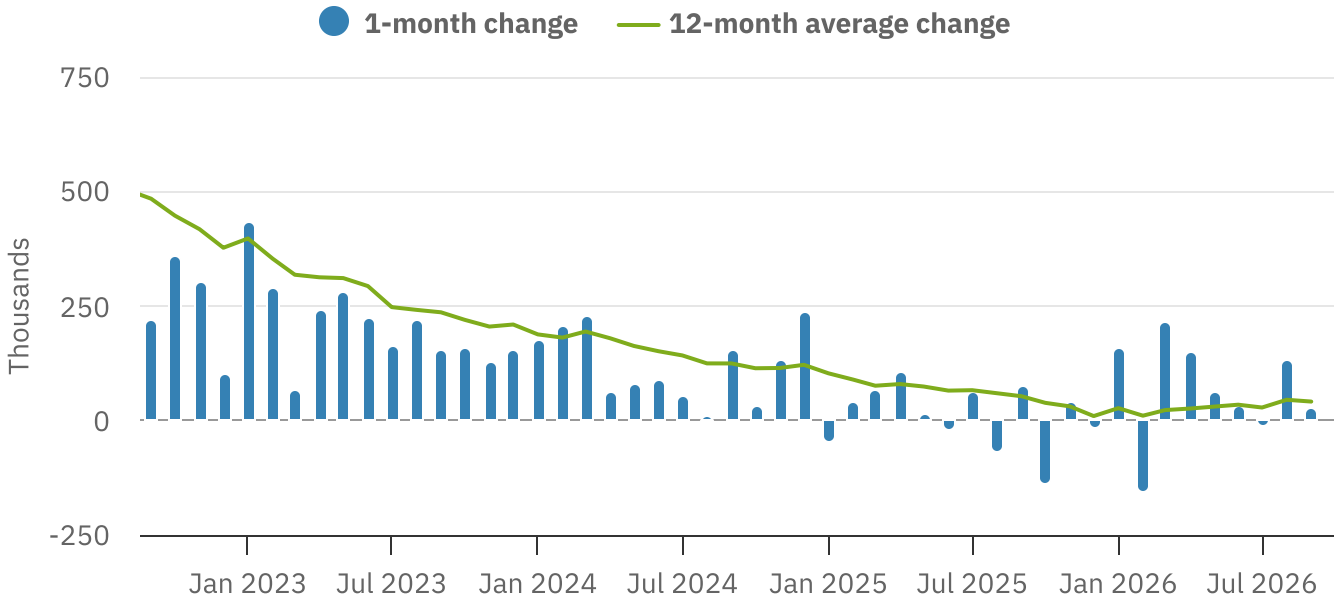


Sources: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics Summary Table B and Table B-3, Establishment data; Haver Analytics; Atlanta Fed calculations

Employment

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Note: Click on individual series in legend to add or remove from chart



Note: Employment estimate is for nonfarm, seasonally adjusted data. Data are through September 2026.
Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics Summary Table B, Establishment data; Haver Analytics

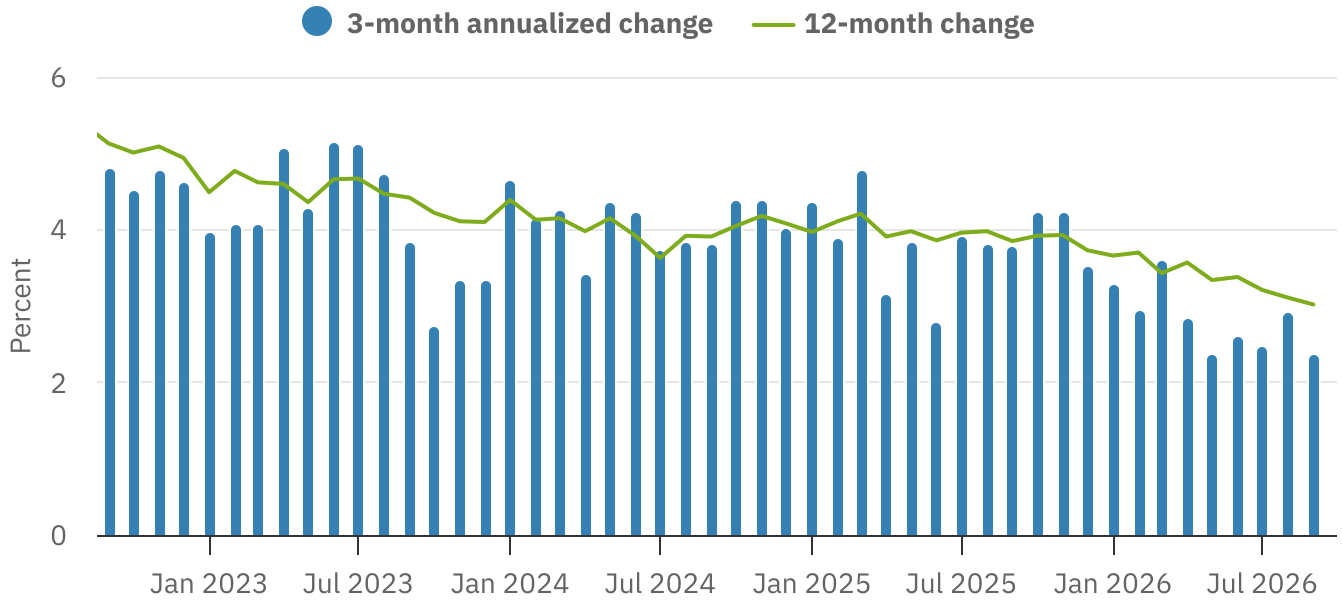
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Average Hourly Earnings

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Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics Summary Table B, Establishment data; Haver Analytics



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LABOR FORCE STATISTICS	CURRENT RATE	1 MONTH AGO	12 MONTHS AGO
Unemployment rates			
Headline (U-3)	4.2%	4.1%	4.3%
Broad (U-6)	7.6%	7.7%	8.1%
Labor force participation rates			
Age 16+	61.8%	61.6%	62.3%

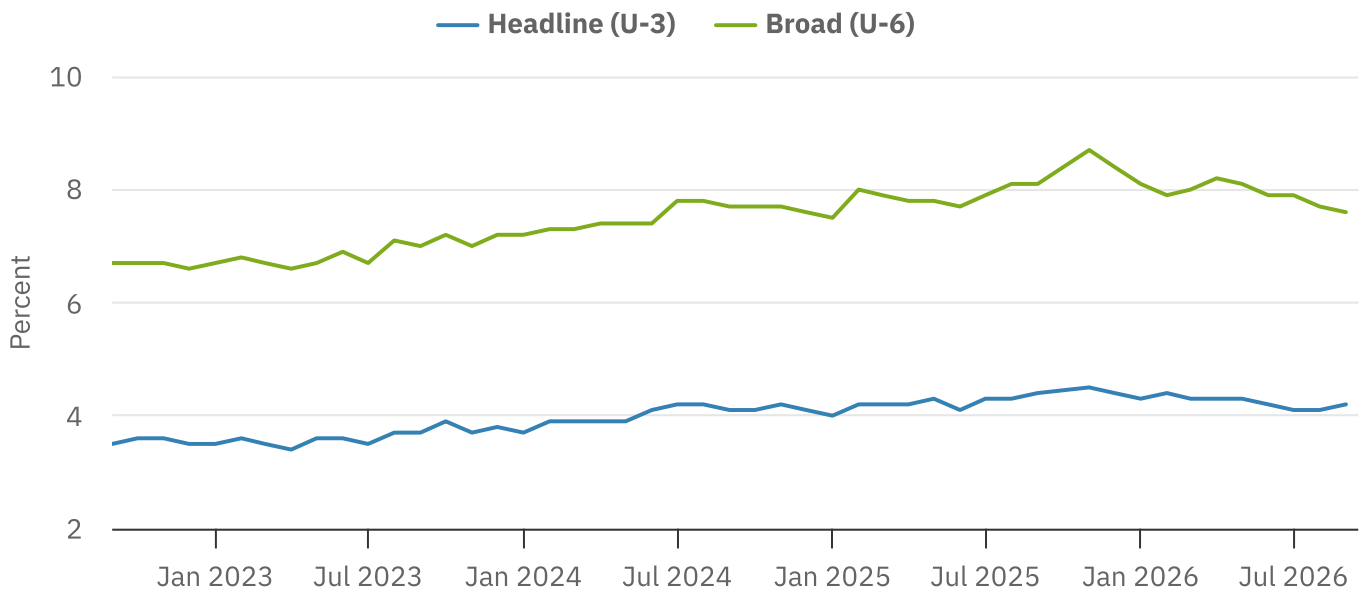
LABOR FORCE STATISTICS	CURRENT RATE	1 MONTH AGO	12 MONTHS AGO
Age 25–54 (prime)	83.7%	83.4%	83.7%
Age 25–54, women	78%	77.8%	77.8%
Age 25–54, men	89.5%	89.2%	89.8%

Note: Data are seasonally adjusted. The K denotes thousands of people.
[1] The underutilization rate is the share of the population who are unemployed or underemployed (working part-time for economic reasons), or who want a job but are not in the labor force.
[2] The job-finding rate is the share of unemployed last month who are employed this month.

Unemployment Rates

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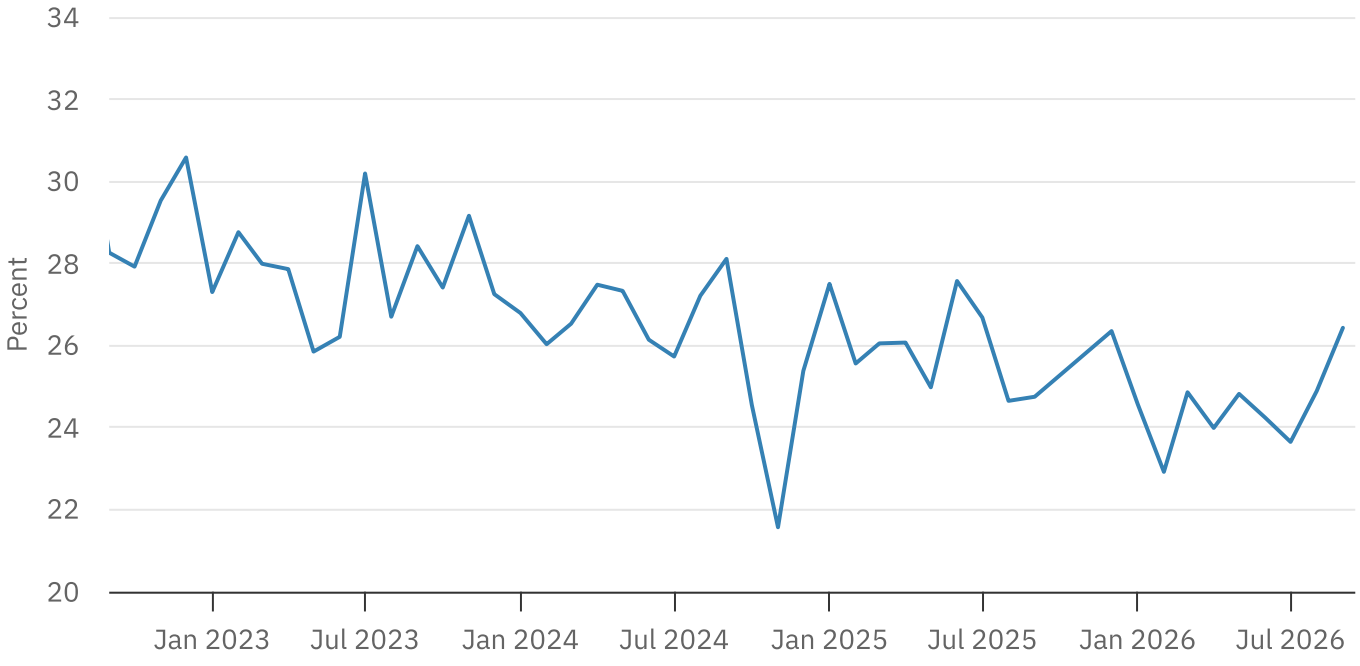
Note: Data are seasonally adjusted and through September 2026. October 2025 data not collected by the Bureau of Labor Statistics.
Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics Summary Tables A and A-16, Household data; Haver Analytics

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Job Finding Rate

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Note: The job-finding rate is the share of umemployed last montth who are employed this months. Data rare seasonally-adjusted through September 2026.
Sources: Bureau of Labor Statistics research series on labor force status flows; Haver Analytics; FRB Atlanta calculations

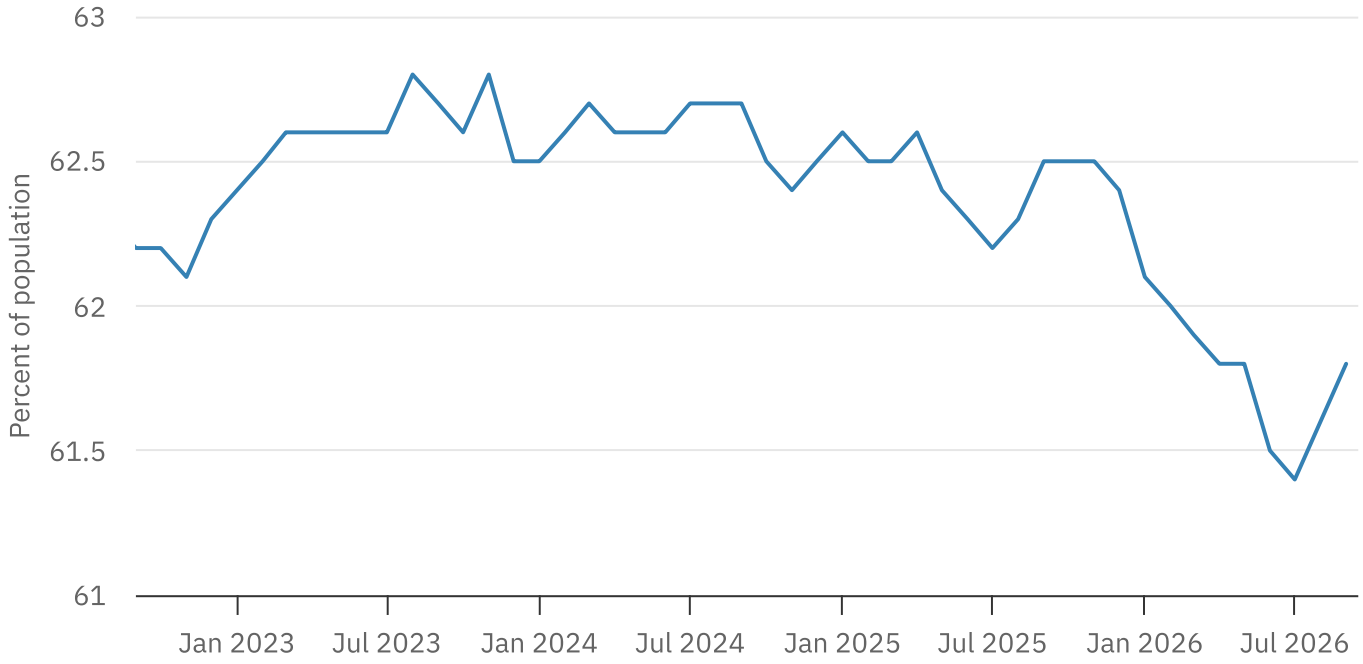
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Labor Force Participation Rates

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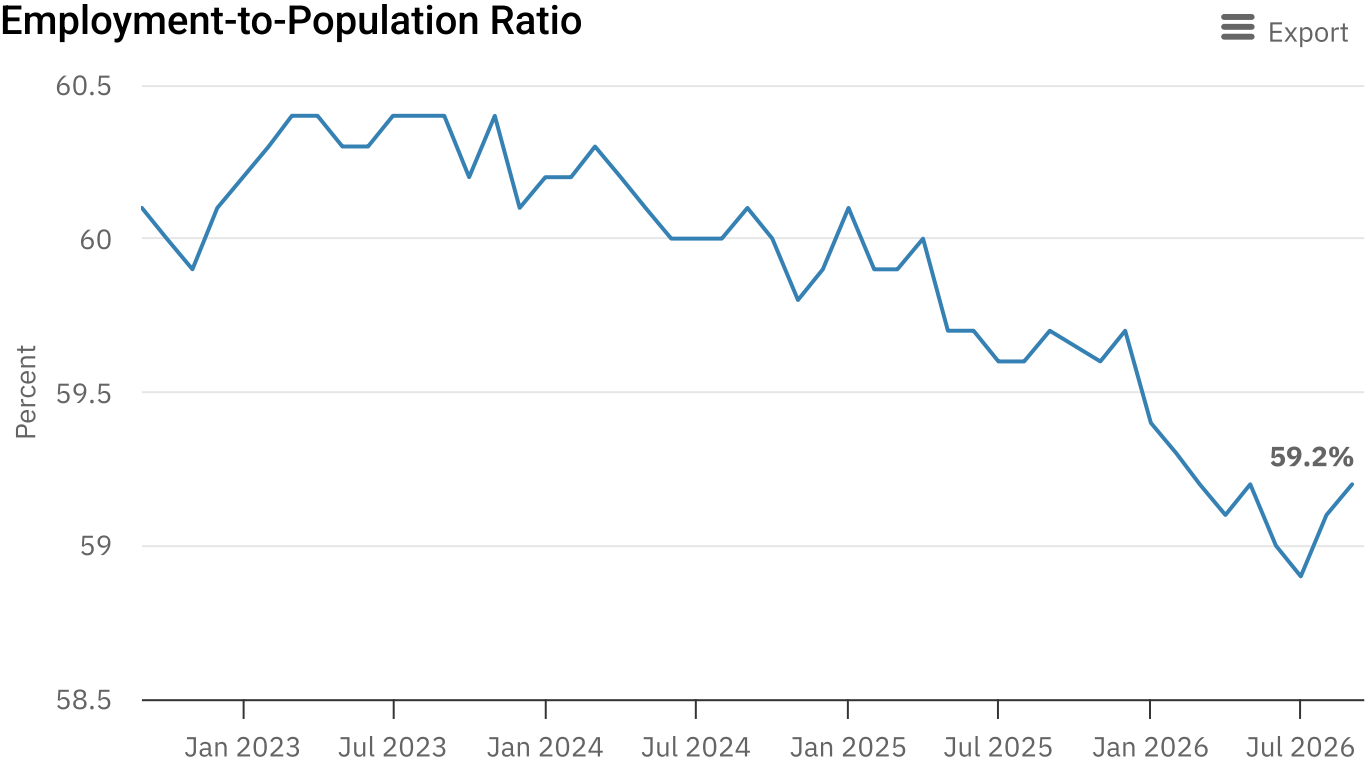


Note: Data are seasonally adjusted and through September 2026. October 2025 data not collected by the Bureau of Labor Statistics.
Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics Summary Tables A and A-9, Household data; Haver Analytics



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Employment-to-Population Ratio



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Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics Summary Tables A and A-9, Household data; Haver Analytics

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Reset

	CURRENT RATE	1 MONTH AGO	12 MONTHS AGO
All, 16+	4.2%	4.1%	4.3%
Gender			
Men	4.3%	4.4%	4.4%
Women	4%	3.9%	4.3%
Race or ethnicity			

	CURRENT RATE	1 MONTH AGO	12 MONTHS AGO
White	3.6%	3.7%	3.7%
Black or African American	7%	6%	7.6%
Asian	2.9%	3.2%	3.6%
Hispanic or Latino ethnicity	4.7%	4.8%	5.3%
Age			
16–19	14.5%	14.1%	13.9%
20–24	8%	7.1%	9.2%
25–54	3.6%	3.6%	3.6%
55+	2.6%	3%	2.9%
Educational attainment			
All, 25+	3.3%	3.4%	3.4%
Less than high school diploma	4.3%	4.7%	6.7%
High school graduates, no college	4.4%	4.4%	4.3%
Some college or associate degree	3.6%	3.7%	3.2%
Bachelor's degree or higher	2.5%	2.7%	2.7%

Demographic Unemployment Rates, September 2026

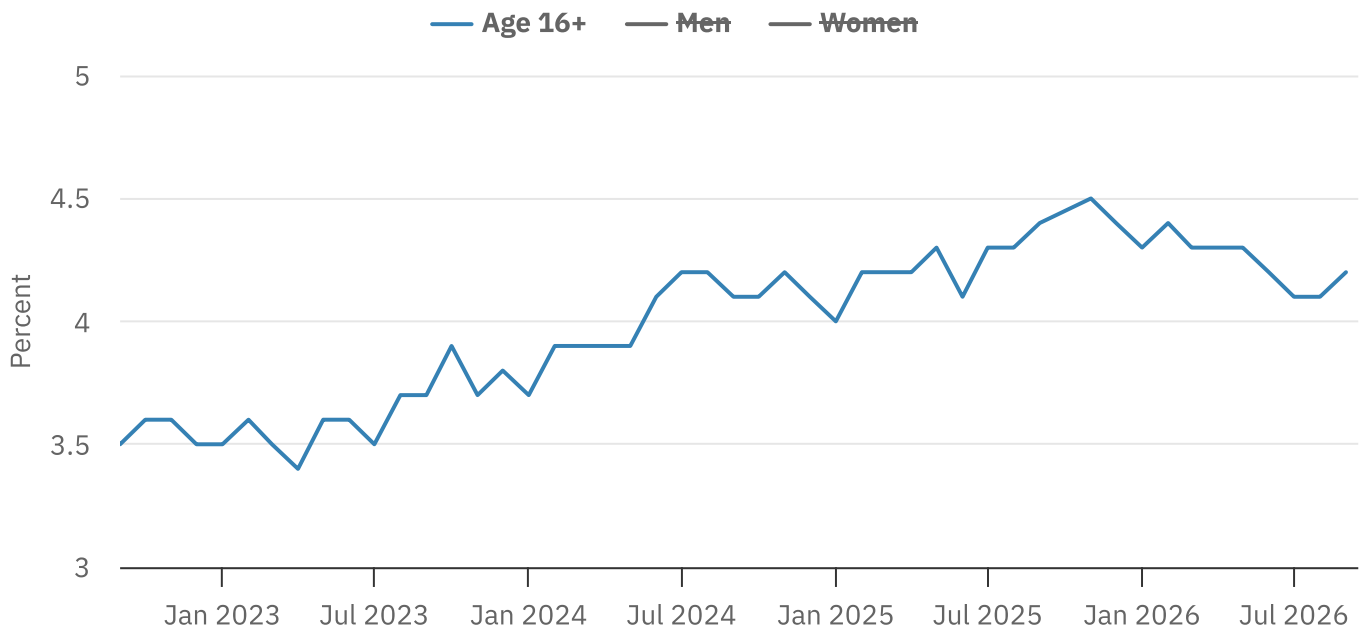
Note: Data are seasonally adjusted.

Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics Summary Tables A, A-1, A-2, A-3, A-4, and A-10, Household data; Haver Analytics

Unemployment Rates by Gender

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Note: Click on individual series in legend to add or remove from chart



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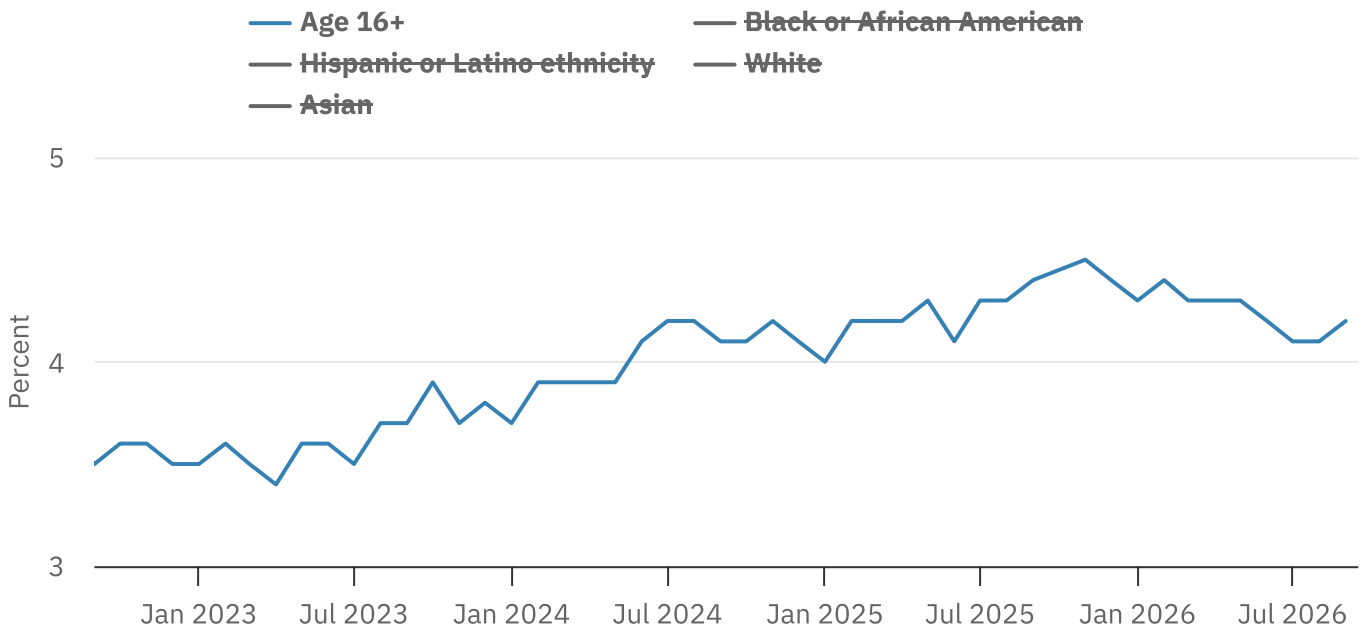


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Unemployment Rates by Race or Ethnicity

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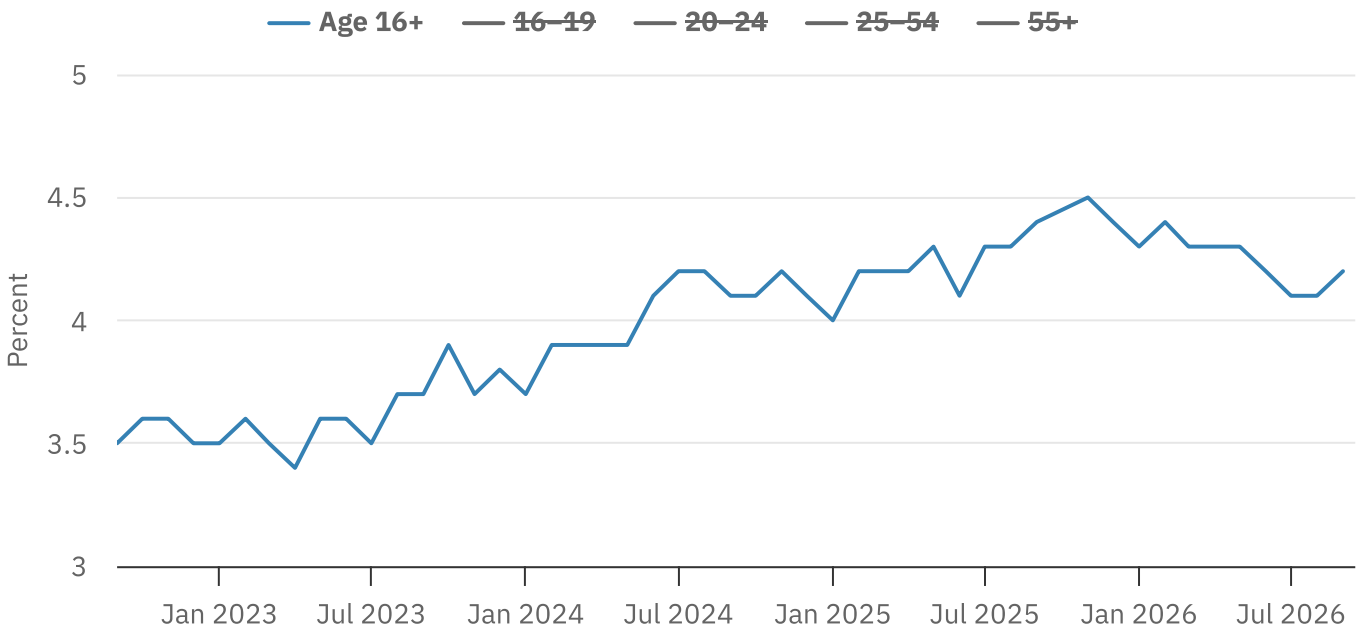


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Unemployment Rates by Age

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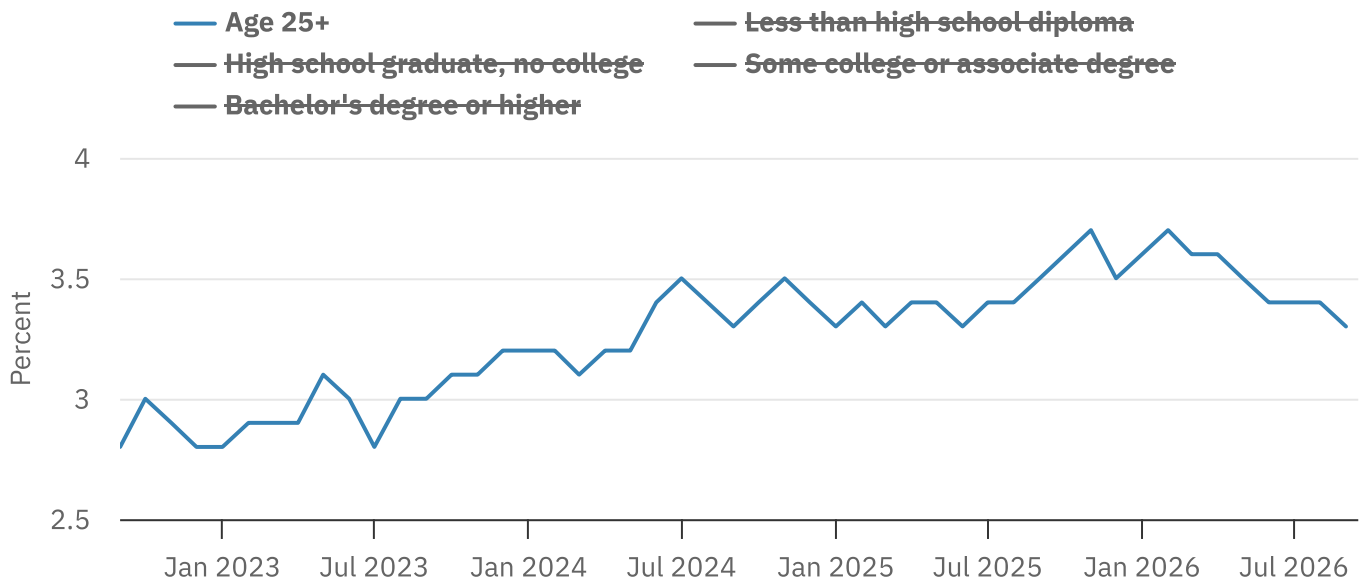


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Unemployment Rates by Educational Attainment (25 years and older)

Export

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Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics Summary Tables A and A-9, Household data; Haver Analytics



Reset

	CURRENT RATE	1 MONTH AGO	12 MONTHS AGO
All, 16+	61.8%	61.6%	62.3%
Gender			
Men	67.2%	67.2%	67.9%
Women	56.7%	56.5%	57%
Race or ethnicity			

	CURRENT RATE	1 MONTH AGO	12 MONTHS AGO
White	61%	60.9%	61.8%
Black or African American	62.5%	61.6%	62.6%
Asian	65.5%	65%	65%
Hispanic or Latino ethnicity	68.1%	67.4%	67%
Age			
16–19	37%	35.7%	34.8%
20–24	71.5%	70.9%	70.3%
25–54	83.7%	83.4%	83.7%
55+	36.9%	37.2%	38.1%
Educational attainment			
All, 25+	62.7%	62.7%	63.6%
Less than high school diploma	44.3%	44.7%	47.5%
High school graduates, no college	55.9%	56.1%	56.9%
Some college or associate degree	61.5%	61.8%	63.6%
Bachelor's degree or higher	71.5%	71.1%	71.6%

Demographic Unemployment Rates, September 2026

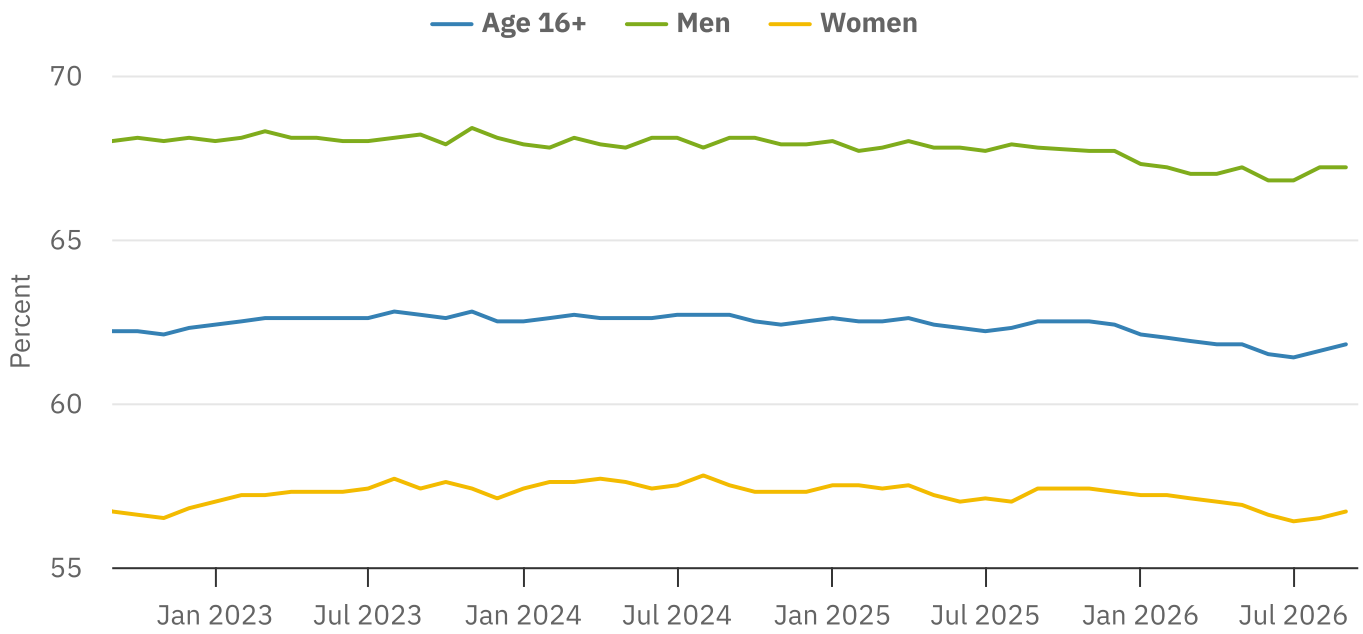
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Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics Summary Tables A, A-1, A-2, A-3, A-4, and A-10, Household data; Haver Analytics

Participation Rates by Gender

Export

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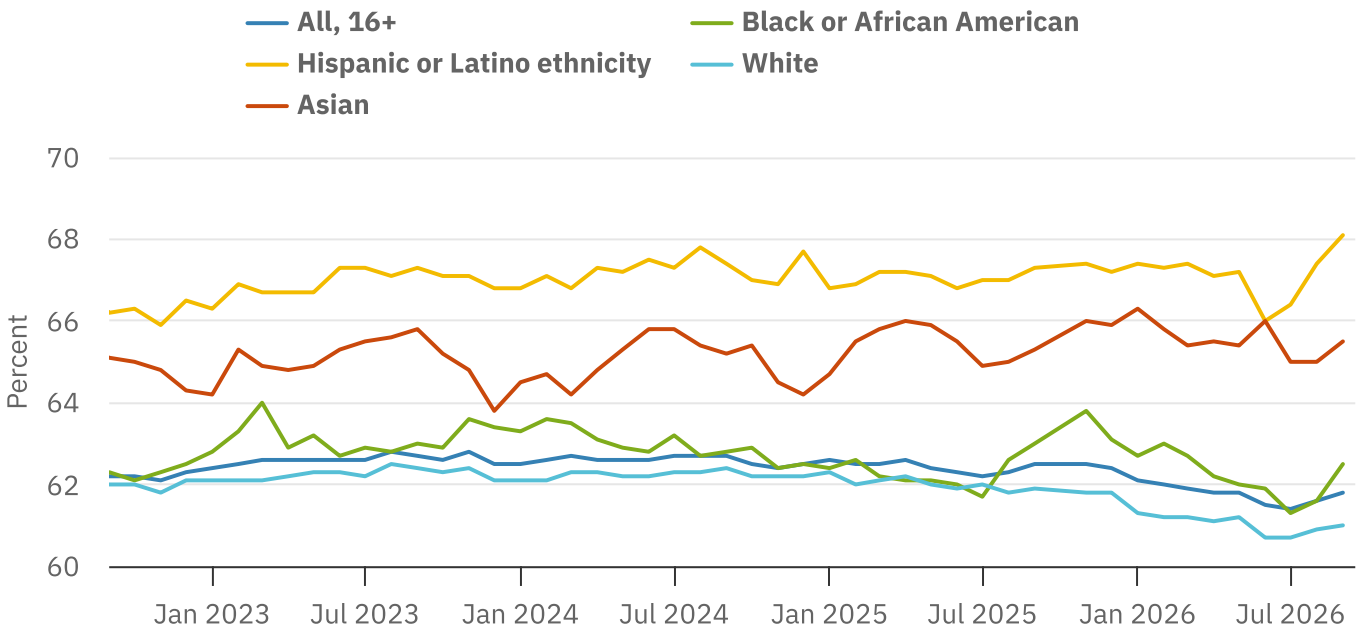


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Participation Rates by Race or Ethnicity

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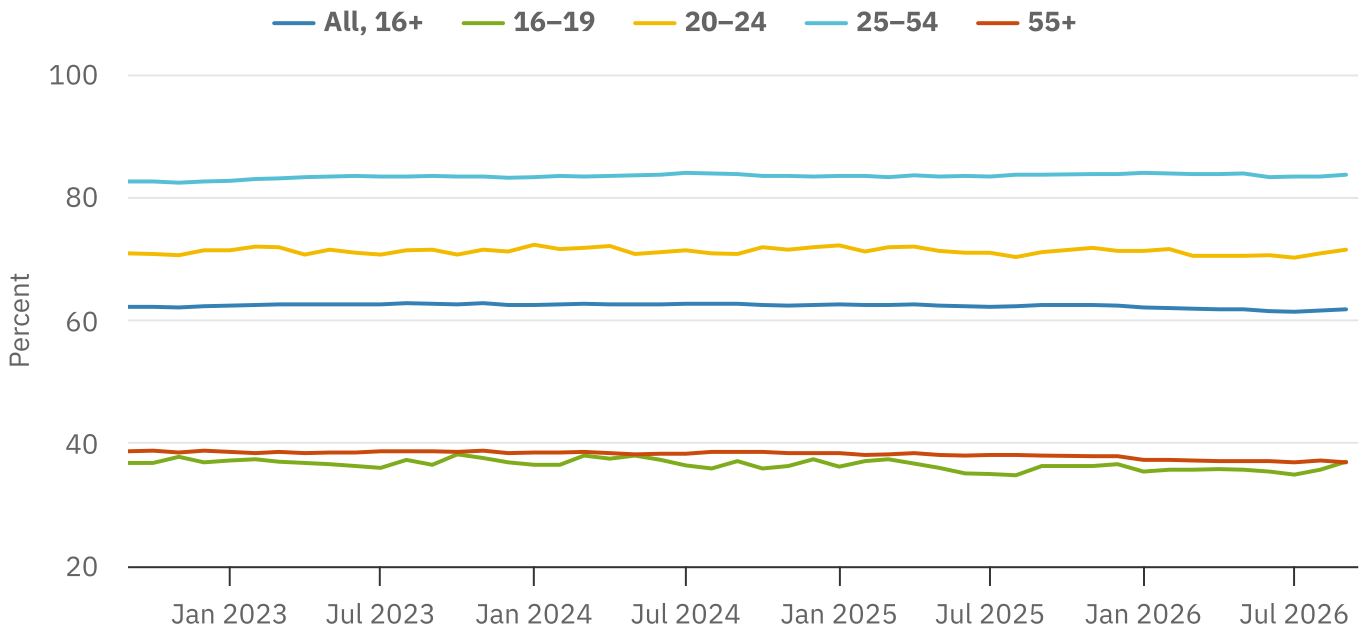
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Participation Rates by Age

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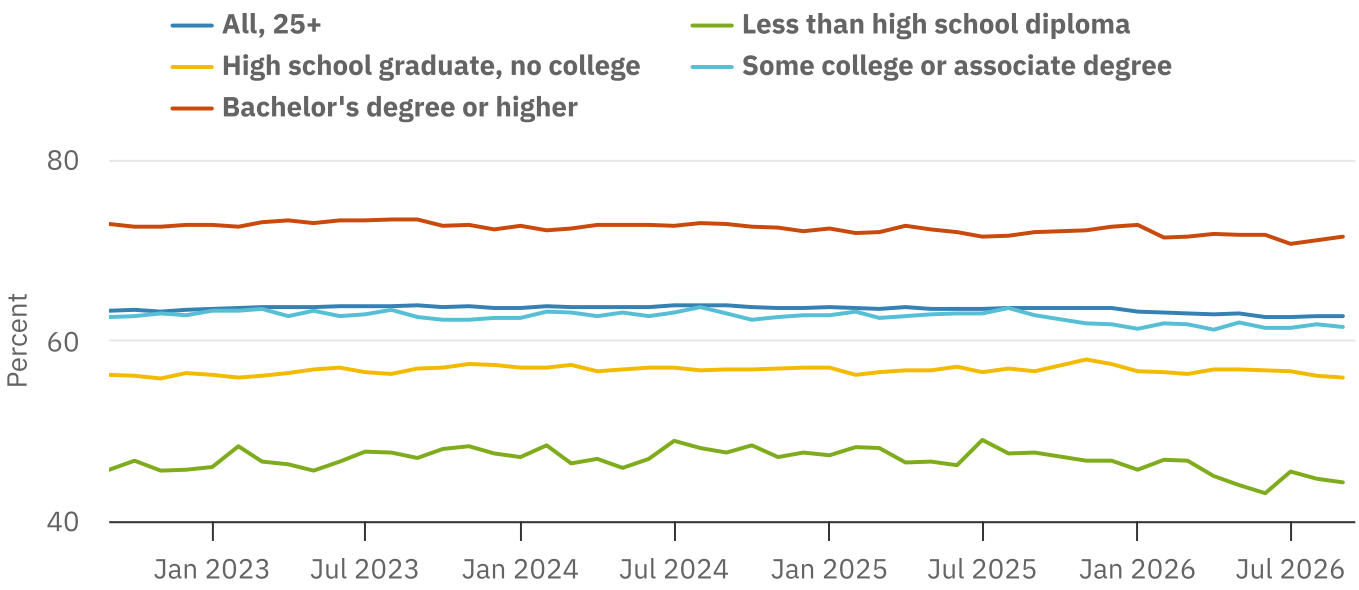


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Participation Rates by Educational Attainment (25 years and older)

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